

Pilot Diagnostic Audit - Independent Tattoo Studio

Anonymous Independent Tattoo Studio

AUDIT VELAR-2026-001	PREPARED BY Veronika Katasonova
MARKET Ukraine	VERSION 1.0

Evidence-led diagnosis | Prioritized constraints | Actionable roadmap

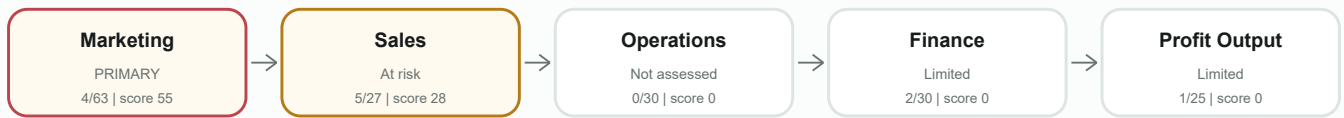
What currently limits the business flow

The audit reviewed 12 of 175 diagnostic hypotheses and confirmed 4 issues. The current primary constraint is Marketing runs in bursts without a system.

Leads	Lead -> Customer Conversion	Average Response Time	Revenue
-	90	1	-
	%	hour	

PRIMARY FLOW	PRIMARY CONSTRAINT	CHECKED	CONFIRMED FINDINGS WITH EVIDENCE
Marketing	Marketing runs in bursts without a system	12/175	100%

Where the flow slows, leaks or becomes unstable



Flow risk profile



BUSINESS MODEL	AUDIT SCOPE
B2C appointment-based service business operated by a sole owner.	Limited pilot diagnostic covering Marketing and Sales. Finance, Profit and detailed service delivery analysis are excluded because supporting operational and financial data were not provided.
MAIN OFFER	ACCESS LIMITATIONS
Custom artistic tattoos, tattoo cover-ups, corrections and individual sketch development.	The audit is based on a structured owner interview. No access was provided to advertising accounts, financial tables, messaging history, calendar data or customer records.
TARGET CUSTOMER	
Individual clients interested in custom tattoos, corrections or cover-ups.	

Why this issue is addressed first

Marketing runs in bursts without a system

This diagnostic hypothesis checks whether "marketing runs in bursts without a system" is present and materially affects the business.

EVIDENCE	BUSINESS CONSEQUENCE
The owner stated that promotion should ideally follow a plan, but currently advertising and social media activity are intensified mainly when additional demand is needed. She also reported that increased advertising and more active social media management generally produce more bookings.	Acquisition activity begins mainly after demand has already declined. This reinforces fluctuations in the booking flow, reduces predictability and makes the studio react to low-demand periods instead of preparing for them in advance.
CONFIDENCE	DECISION BASIS
75% Moderate evidence 55/100	Causal role: Contributing Cause. The auditor selected this as the single Primary Constraint.

Causal chain

ROOT CAUSE	CONTRIBUTING CAUSES	OBSERVED SYMPTOMS	BUSINESS EFFECT
Not classified	Marketing runs in bursts without a system	Unstable lead flow	Acquisition activity begins mainly after demand has already declined. This reinforces fluctuations in the booking flow, reduces predictability and makes the studio react to low-demand periods instead of preparing for them in advance.

The issues that explain the largest business effect

1 Marketing runs in bursts without a system 55/100			
FLOW	TYPE	CAUSAL ROLE	EVIDENCE
Marketing	Operational Turbulence	Contributing Cause	Moderate
EVIDENCE SUMMARY	BUSINESS CONSEQUENCE	SOLUTION DIRECTION	PRIORITY
The owner stated that promotion should ideally follow a plan, but currently advertising and social media activity are intensified mainly when additional demand is needed. She also reported that increased advertising and more active social media management generally produce more bookings.	Acquisition activity begins mainly after demand has already declined. This reinforces fluctuations in the booking flow, reduces predictability and makes the studio react to low-demand periods instead of preparing for them in advance.	Introduce a lightweight four-week promotion cycle that continues regardless of the current booking level. Define a minimum weekly rhythm for portfolio content, educational content, referral activity and paid promotion. Review inquiries, bookings, conversion and advertising cost once a week and adjust campaign intensity before the schedule becomes underfilled.	P1 - Primary Constraint

2 Unstable lead flow 46/100			
FLOW	TYPE	CAUSAL ROLE	EVIDENCE
Marketing	Scale Risk	Symptom	Moderate
EVIDENCE SUMMARY	BUSINESS CONSEQUENCE	SOLUTION DIRECTION	PRIORITY
The owner reports approximately 5-15 bookings per month. Booking volume varies substantially depending on season, advertising activity and social media activity. Demand is generally higher during spring and summer and lower during autumn and winter. The studio is also affected by safety concerns related to its near-frontline location.	The variation in monthly bookings makes workload and income less predictable. The owner cannot reliably estimate how many bookings the studio will receive in the following month or how much promotional activity will be required to maintain demand.	Separate uncontrollable factors, such as seasonality and local safety conditions, from manageable acquisition activity. Establish a minimum continuous marketing rhythm, track inquiries and bookings by week and channel, and prepare a separate promotion plan for naturally weaker months.	P3 - Bottleneck / Stability

3

No single place for all leads**28/100**

FLOW	TYPE	CAUSAL ROLE	EVIDENCE
Sales	Operational Turbulence	Standalone	Moderate
EVIDENCE SUMMARY	BUSINESS CONSEQUENCE	SOLUTION DIRECTION	PRIORITY
Client inquiries arrive through Instagram, Viber, Telegram, WhatsApp and phone calls. There is no single register containing all inquiries and their current statuses. The owner reported that messages are lost or left unanswered only rarely.	The current process is manageable at a low inquiry volume, but fragmented channels create a risk of missed messages, incomplete lead history and inconsistent tracking as inquiry volume increases.	Create a simple Google Sheets lead register instead of implementing a complex CRM. Record the inquiry date, client code, source channel, requested service, current status, next action, booking result and expected booking value.	P4 - Optimization / Monitor

4

Follow-up depends on the manager's memory**28/100**

FLOW	TYPE	CAUSAL ROLE	EVIDENCE
Sales	Operational Turbulence	Standalone	Moderate
EVIDENCE SUMMARY	BUSINESS CONSEQUENCE	SOLUTION DIRECTION	PRIORITY
The owner consistently follows up with potential clients who have not provided a final answer. However, the required next action and follow-up timing are kept in her memory or saved in unstructured phone notes rather than recorded in a shared lead register or calendar.	The process currently works because inquiry volume is relatively low and the owner personally controls every conversation. As the number of inquiries increases, reliance on memory may lead to delayed or missed follow-ups.	For every undecided inquiry, record a specific next action and follow-up date in the lead register or Google Calendar. Keep the existing personal communication approach while removing the need to remember every unfinished conversation.	P4 - Optimization / Monitor

What already works and should not be broken

STRENGTH	EVIDENCE	PRESERVE
Effective prepayment and cancellation policy	The owner reported that cancellations and no-shows decreased from approximately 35% to 5% after prepayment became mandatory. The remaining amount is paid after the service. Cancellations made more than 24 hours in advance may be refunded or transferred, while later cancellations are non-refundable.	Preserve the requirement to confirm bookings through prepayment and retain the clear 24-hour cancellation and rescheduling rules. Future process changes must not weaken booking commitment or increase the cancellation rate.
Strong inquiry-to-booking conversion	The owner estimates that approximately 90% of inquiries result in confirmed bookings. She actively follows up with undecided prospects and seeks a clear final response instead of abandoning the conversation.	Preserve the owner's personal, responsive communication style and consistent follow-up approach. Lead-tracking improvements should support the existing process rather than replace it with impersonal or excessive automation.
Fast response to new inquiries	The owner usually responds to new inquiries within one hour. Longer response times occur only when she is temporarily unavailable or actively providing a service.	Preserve the current responsive communication standard. Any new lead-tracking process should remain lightweight and must not add unnecessary administrative work that delays the first response.
Meaningful repeat-client base	The owner estimates that approximately 40% of clients return for another service. She also reminds clients about corrections when the tattoo location or condition makes a future correction appropriate.	Preserve the personal client relationship and relevant correction reminders. Future marketing improvements should support repeat bookings without sending unnecessary or generic messages to every client.

What to change, in what order, and how success will be measured

Phase 1 - Fix Primary Constraint

Implement a minimum four-week promotion cycle

RELATED ISSUES	OWNER	EFFORT	TARGET DATE	STATUS
M-A04; M-A02	Studio Owner	M	30.09.2026	Not Started

EXPECTED IMPACT

Reduce gaps in acquisition activity and make the booking flow more predictable. The studio should begin responding to expected seasonal changes before the schedule becomes underfilled rather than increasing promotion only after demand has already declined.

SUCCESS METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET
Share of planned weekly promotion activities completed	Promotion increases mainly when additional demand is already needed	At least 80% of planned activities completed for 4 consecutive weeks

DEPENDENCY

Define available booking capacity, a realistic content workload and the maximum monthly advertising budget.

NOTES / SCOPE

The cycle should remain realistic for a one-person studio and does not require daily publication. It may combine portfolio posts, educational content, before-and-after examples, referral activity and paid promotion. Personal communication and service delivery must remain the priority.

Create a lightweight lead and follow-up register

RELATED ISSUES	OWNER	EFFORT	TARGET DATE	STATUS
S-A02; S-C02; M-A02	Studio Owner	S	05.09.2026	Not Started

EXPECTED IMPACT

Create one reliable view of inquiries from all communication channels, reduce dependence on memory and provide the data required to measure booking flow, conversion and channel effectiveness.

SUCCESS METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET
Share of new inquiries recorded with a current status and dated next action	Inquiries arrive through five channels; follow-ups are remembered or stored in phone notes	100% of new inquiries recorded for 4 consecutive weeks

DEPENDENCY

Create a simple Google Sheets template and define a daily 5-10 minute update routine.

NOTES / SCOPE

Do not implement a complex CRM. Record only the inquiry date, anonymous client code, channel, requested service, status, next action date, booking result and expected value. Do not store sensitive customer information in the pilot register.

Phase 3 - Stabilize Operations

Introduce a 15-minute weekly acquisition review

RELATED ISSUES	OWNER	EFFORT	TARGET DATE	STATUS
S-A02; M-A02; M-A04	Studio Owner	XS	12.09.2026	Not Started

EXPECTED IMPACT

Provide early visibility into changes in demand and allow the owner to adjust promotion before booking volume becomes critically low. The review will also show whether advertising and content activity produce actual bookings rather than only engagement.

SUCCESS METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET
Number of consecutive weekly acquisition reviews completed	No consolidated weekly review of inquiries, bookings and promotion activity	4 consecutive weekly reviews completed

DEPENDENCY

Requires the lead register and basic advertising cost data.

NOTES / SCOPE

Review only essential indicators: inquiries, confirmed bookings, conversion rate, acquisition source, advertising cost, cost per confirmed booking, cancellations and repeat-client share. The review should take no more than 15 minutes.

Prepare a targeted promotion plan for the lower-demand season

RELATED ISSUES	OWNER	EFFORT	TARGET DATE	STATUS
M-A02; M-A04	Studio Owner	M	20.09.2026	Not Started

EXPECTED IMPACT

Reduce the seasonal decline in bookings by starting relevant promotion before demand falls. The plan should create a more stable baseline of inquiries without relying only on discounts or emergency advertising.

SUCCESS METRIC	BASELINE	TARGET
Low-season campaign prepared and launched before the expected demand decline	Promotion is intensified mainly after the studio needs more demand	One documented low-season campaign launched with defined content, budget and booking metrics

DEPENDENCY

Review previous seasonal booking patterns, available capacity and advertising performance.

NOTES / SCOPE

The campaign may explain the advantages of tattoo healing during cooler months, reuse portfolio and correction cases, encourage relevant repeat bookings and activate referrals. Avoid broad discounting that could reduce perceived value or profitability.

Reviewed diagnostic hypotheses

ID	FLOW	PROBLEM	STATUS	EVIDENCE	SCORE	ROLE
M-A02	Marketing	Unstable lead flow	Confirmed	Moderate	46	Symptom
M-A04	Marketing	Marketing runs in bursts without a system	Confirmed	Moderate	55	Contributing Cause
M-G06	Marketing	Budget is spent on channels without a clear result	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified
M-J01	Marketing	Lead sources are unclear	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified
S-A02	Sales	No single place for all leads	Confirmed	Moderate	28	Standalone
S-B01	Sales	Slow response to inquiries	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified
S-C01	Sales	No follow-up after the first contact	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified
S-C02	Sales	Follow-up depends on the manager's memory	Confirmed	Moderate	28	Standalone
S-D05	Sales	Low lead-to-customer conversion	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified
F-A03	Finance	No revenue breakdown by sales channel	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified
F-D04	Finance	No rules for prepayment or milestone payments	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified
P-C01	Profit Output	Customers do not return after the first purchase	Not Present	Moderate		Unclassified